

2EQ IN A NUTSHELL

A SIMPLE BUT COMPREHENSIVE OVERVIEW OF THE 2EQ PARADIGM

PART I: THE DIAGNOSIS

SECTION 1: THE BLIND SPOT

Introduction: We begin by observing the fundamental contradiction of the modern age. Despite our external success, our internal state remains fractured. This section proposes that this fracture is not complex, but singular.

The Blind Spot of the Human Mind: A Path to True Well-being

We live in a time of incredible paradox. On one hand, we seem to be facing an increasing number of existential threats: climate change, geopolitical instability, the future of AI. Whilst on the other side we also stand on the brink of unprecedented scientific progress, all of which seems to offer an equal measure of hope. And through it all, we just can't figure out which one of these horses is going to win the race, and decide our ultimate fate.

A relentless torrent of information bombards us, each promising the next big thing, the most urgent crisis, the definitive solution. Yet, for millions - and as Thoreau once said - the underlying human condition for so many people remains one of quiet desperation. We are advanced, but are we truly well?

What if, amidst this overwhelming noise, something far more fundamental is still being overlooked? I'm going to propose here that our collective inability to find lasting well-being points to a singular, pervasive problem. If it is true, then it is an issue that stands apart in a sense, untouched by all these external changes, all these hopes and fears. It could be our true problem, our core problem, the one which - if unaddressed - will forever lock us into our current struggles. But also the one which - if it is addressed - could change everything, for everyone, and also very rapidly.

So my only aim is to invite you to consider: "What if?" So that, by the end, you can at least say that you grasp the basic outlines of what is being claimed, along with some of its very dramatic implications.

SECTION 2: THE GLITCH IN OUR SOFTWARE

Introduction: If the problem is singular, where did it come from? Here, we move from sociology to evolutionary biology. We posit that human unhappiness is not a "feature" of life, but a specific, identifiable "bug" in our system.

The Glitch in Our Software

Something isn't quite right with us. We've picked at this puzzle for centuries, yet human psychology remains largely enigmatic. We dissect it, measure it, theorize about it. But our personal experiences - our consciousness, our motivations, our often-conflicted tendencies - remain deeply confusing. The persistent dissatisfaction many feel, even in lives of privilege, suggests something profoundly amiss.

My argument here will be this: there really is a profound problem with human life, but that its true origins and nature have been deeply misunderstood. We constantly look externally for a cause that is actually coming from within us. And seeing that issue turns out to be quite the challenge; because it likes to hide.

Consider our evolutionary trajectory. The forms of intelligence we see in ourselves and other species are all part of a kind of cognitive arms race. But we seem to have won the lotto in that sense, and suddenly leapt ahead. We acquired a hardware upgrade: a uniquely capable brain structure. And this allowed us to run new, sophisticated software: abstract thought, complex language, imagination.

Unlike other animals, who live in perpetual submission to genetically inherited patterns of behavior, we suddenly gained the ability not only to act in more adaptive ways - but also to reflect on our own minds, reprogram our thinking, and even to program the minds of others through the development of culture. And this led to incredible cognitive heights, but this new software also seems to have come with a critical and unexpected bug. A virus, if you will - an issue so ubiquitous, and so deeply embedded, that we've come to simply imagine this afflicted state is what it now means to be "normal".

The result of this hidden knot in our emotional fabric, so to speak, is profound internal conflict and confusion. This entanglement has also made it nearly impossible to distinguish our natural, healthy psychological system from this added, anomalous activity. We mistake the pathology for the baseline. And this is the key insight: when we observe the complexities of human behavior, we're actually looking at **two things, not one**.

Crucially, this added event is singular and extrinsic. It has a single active origin, and while its emergence might be natural, it is not native to us in the sense that it is necessary or unavoidable. This implies, shockingly, that it can be **removed**.

SECTION 3: THE MECHANICS OF ILLUSION

Introduction: What are the origins of this "virus," and how does it survive detection? In both cases it exploits our greatest asset: imagination. This section defines the origins of the central crisis - the creation of a "pseudo-reality" - and also one of the mechanisms of concealment that distracts the conscious mind from the underlying error.

The Problem of Imagined Realities

How did this psychological virus arise? Consider imagination for a moment. It's an astonishing faculty. But it also emerged as part of a complex navigational system that constantly generates an extended overlay on our direct perception of reality - a "pseudo-reality" if you will.

We are so deeply invested in this projection that we are largely unaware we are even doing it. In essence, we experience two types of reality: one actually real, the other just a complex framework of spurious beliefs - an artifact of our own mental functioning. This second layer is designed to feel real, but ultimately, it's actually just a convoluted trick of the mind.

What if your newly augmented capacity for imagination was smart enough to make some educated guesses, but what if it wasn't quite smart enough to get it right when it came to a few of the biggest questions of all? And what if one or two really basic errors in what we might call our 'cosmological' or 'existential' context had the unfortunate ability to cause a truly devastating emotional dilemma.

How would you contain the resulting crisis? The unconscious, responsible for this overlay, would eventually be forced to deconstruct the emerging conflict to prevent conscious attention from spiraling into an endless, irresolvable problem. It wouldn't even know where this fire had come from necessarily, it would only know it has to put it out.

The unconscious then becomes tasked with permanently concealing this explosive possibility from conscious view. But in a system so deeply built around awareness as one of its defining functions, keeping something so vital hidden will always create deep, persistent stress. And who feels that stress? The conscious self feels it. So it's forever caught in the middle of something it can't understand.

This convoluted dynamic manifests in many ways. It's like two slippery combatants locked in a perpetual fight - one trying to hide something, the other trying to expose it. But if ever the latter succeeds, the result is immediate panic, as the former then needs to step back in and re-bury the offending artifact with one of its subversive concealment patterns, or what we might call its various "limbs".

Hence, we sometimes use the metaphor of having a big **unconscious octopus** with us in our little conscious fish tank of a mind. This "octopus" is very good at hiding in plain sight, but it also generates a huge amount of "ink" at times, in the form of even more outrageous fictions than the original mistakes that caused all this trouble in the first place.

We throw out the baby and keep the bathwater, and this is why there is so much mess and confusion. This creates a kind of out-of-control "bullshit generator". Imagination, the very thing that sparked the whole crisis to begin with, is then sent into overdrive in order to try to cover it up. We escape from real life into distraction and fantasy to try to tidy up the mess we made.

This is why science is important, and why clear rational thinking becomes the way forward. It is because logic and evidence are our best methods of sorting out what is actually real from what is just carefully manufactured fiction. We need to at least remove a bit of this ink from the fish tank, just so that we can see. As they say - first, free the mind.

PART II: THE CURE

SECTION 4: THE ANATOMY OF RELEASE

Introduction: If the human condition is defined by a "glitch," what does the architecture of that glitch look like? Here we define the two distinct components of the problem: the explosive potential (the core issue) and the containment mechanism (the defense).

The Great Reveal: A Return to "Normal"

The claim is this: something vast lurks in our depths. An explosive functional crisis. An entirely separate, secondary agenda, playing a game the conscious mind cannot directly access.

This added entity has two parts: the underlying explosive potential, and then all of the unconscious mechanisms that are preventing that from ever occurring again. It is as if this octopus is hiding a **grenade**, if only because the conscious mind keeps wanting to get hold of it and pull the pin.

The octopus and the grenade are not the same thing in this sense, but from the conscious perspective, both events remain equally mysterious.

This secondary agenda is inherently dysfunctional. There is essentially nothing wrong with the functioning that produces this simmering explosive outcome. It's like having a disturbing film loaded into a projector, but the canister is locked. So to prevent any distress, the operator starts tearing the projector apart in order to stop the movie. Basically, to control this potential crisis, our healthy functioning must be subverted.

The key insight here is that there are **two things going on, not one**, and one is not intrinsic to us. We are afflicted. And it's serious.

But think about it - if this is true, what would your unconscious reaction be to this information being revealed? Resistance, right? Everything would tell you to back away, turn around, and run for the hills. And this is precisely how the problem has maintained itself over time.

This aspect isn't new, however, and about that part there really isn't much doubt now. As far back as the 1970s, Ernest Becker proposed that humans are essentially "on fire" in some deep sense. And a view named Terror Management Theory has since empirically validated this insight: something profound and terrifying really is hidden in our depths. Yet, such views never did capture this issue with enough resolution to tease apart the aspects that truly matter: that this added activity is singular, integrated, and **extrinsic**.

Consider the implication: what this insight implies, shockingly, is that it can be **removed**. Not easily as it turns out, but given its profound impact, just the mere possibility of its removal is a bombshell. Like a computer virus once again, the moment it is isolated and understood, suddenly an antivirus program becomes possible.

SECTION 5: THE WRIGHT BROTHERS MOMENT

Introduction: If this condition is removable, why hasn't it happened before? This section argues that it *has* happened, historically called "Enlightenment," but was misunderstood. We propose moving from accidental "miracles" to repeatable engineering - the "Wright Brothers" shift.

The Wright Brothers Moment: A Tipping Point for Humanity

If it is possible, why haven't we seen it? But perhaps we have.

Consider for a moment: from this state of cultural and psychological captivity, where 'all computers have this virus', how would such a "release event" in any single individual be perceived from a distance? It would look like the "liberated" computer suddenly got some kind of "miraculous" upgrade.

And here's the connection to an entirely different field: this "falling away" event is almost certainly what has been historically called "awakening," "self-realization," or "spiritual enlightenment". But if so, then it has certainly been dramatically misrepresented. Most people who find this release apparently weren't even looking for it - they didn't understand the "virus" when they had it, and therefore don't truly understand its absence now that it has gone.

So imagine two storyboards:

On one, Becker and the common person: a deep problem identified, but no functional anatomy. On the other, the "awakened masters": they have the answer, but it's an empty cage. They only know this release exists, they know the simplicity that remains, but not the complexity that was removed.

They are the same thing.

The existential crisis at the heart of Becker's work is absolutely identical to what is missing in anyone "awakened".

One is simply the absence of the other.

Whatever that may turn out to be, this feature is totally unambiguous - they never revert to their previous state. Not ever. It is a one way deal. It is not the summit of any psychological mountain. It is actually more akin to a **landslide** - a lowering of complexity, and a release of tension. It is not a developmental shift, but rather a collapse.

This is the inversion here. What you get is **nothing**. You don't become more. It's an absence. It doesn't make you special; it merely restores you to being normal again.

And just as with the Wright brothers and aviation, the resulting development will be completely unstoppable from the moment that initial practical threshold is crossed in a way that can be reliably repeated by any third party.

SECTION 6: THE CLINICAL APPROACH

Introduction: Why do traditional methods fail to produce this "Wright Brothers" reliability? Because they lack the anatomy to distinguish the healthy self from the parasite. This section introduces the core mechanic of 2EQ: separating the two equilibriums.

The Cure: 2EQ and The Path Home

So how does it work, this process of relinquishment?

Imagine a tumor - an added growth causing great discomfort. If it were cancer, chemotherapy or radiation would isolate it from healthy tissue by first of all understanding what makes it different. You wouldn't even need to know more than that. We would simply stop everything, and apply pressure for longer than cancer can last, but shorter than healthy tissue can survive, thereby differentiating and eliminating the pathology.

The same basic principle applies to this ubiquitous, subversive event. That is why we see this as the ultimate aim of all meditative practices: stop the mind. But most apply that injunction incorrectly if the aim is to have a lasting effect on this underlying dilemma.

A little bit of chemo doesn't cure cancer; it might even make it worse. And too much will kill the patient. What you really need is to stop the mind - just once. Truly stop it. But here is the important thing: **not only the mind**. The "metaphorical octopus" has many limbs, some of them deeply visceral. You need to know them all, and apply enough pressure to all of them at once to push the center of gravity of the whole edifice across the defining collapse threshold - and all without damaging healthy functions.

There's no point attempting a rescue if you only end up shooting the hostage in the process. And all current practices fall short in this regard. There are no exceptions.

For this dynamic entrapment, along with how to get out of it, we use the analogy of a **ball in a bowl**. In the common state, the situation is free in a sense, but also fundamentally captured. You can push it up the sides of the bowl with effort, but the moment you let go it will always just roll back down to the middle again.

But what that actually points to, if one of those really can be removed and undone, is that for every individual person there are actually **two stable states** available, rather than just the twisted and distorted one we currently know. There are actually **Two Equilibriums** available to us, hence: **2EQ**.

This is the key thing to know. Another entire bowl exists, separated by a peak of high tension. And you can traverse that stressful threshold if you know how, especially with the right type of support.

PART III: THE STRATEGY

SECTION 7: THE THREE PILLARS

Introduction: We have a map and a theory. But how do we apply this in a world that is actively resisting the cure? Years of failure have taught us that three specific conditions must be met to break the deadlock.

Capture, Conversation, and Qualification: The Path Forward

How can we get out of this mess? We have a truly overwhelming imperative coming into view, but it is also something that most people simply can't see, or won't even look at.

As indicated already, the only obvious exception to this rule is Becker-ism in all its extended forms. But in each case only the problem was being pointed at, never any hint of a solution, so they only had half the picture. They really only winged this bird. And yet, even with that much we see the same underlying social dilemma. All of that sank like a stone. It is even possible you have never heard of Becker, despite being up there with the other heavyweights of his time. And here is the dilemma: nothing sticks within a mile of this point. Like some kind of sociological Chernobyl, it is scorched earth in every direction around this 'ground zero'. Why? Because it is true.

For many years all of this remained stuck in this bond, deadlocked in invisible quicksand. Three main lessons were eventually learned, and these now set the stage for everything that will follow.

1. **Capture is Primary:** The first of these things is that the psychological shock associated with embracing this particular body of awareness is only a temporary effect. It turns out that there is a certain tipping threshold here.

Beyond that point we can see a falling away of a kind of veil that had previously kept the whole thing out of view, so that insight begins to conquer fear. We have come to call this tipping point 'capture.' It is perhaps a bit like the moment when you are piecing together a jigsaw puzzle without knowing what it is a picture of - and you place down just one more piece and suddenly you realise what it all means.

2. **Conversation is Penetration:** The second thing we came to understand is that this 'octopus' is very slippery, and that if all you ever do is just listen passively to a few talks like this, then you will generally not be moving fast enough to catch it.

In conversation, this point of capture appears to be reached many times faster. The aversion is socially canceled out, and suddenly you are kicking this added event all around the room like a football. The moment you begin to provoke it in this way, that's when you wake it up from its calm slumber. Immediately it's like being in a cage with a lion - so having a lion tamer present can be quite a relief.

3. **Qualification is Crucial:** The natural result of the first two is 'cultural development'. But aiming the gun and pulling the trigger aren't enough in that sense - first you need to load it. And it turns out that interest and ability are two completely different things in this context.

What we see emerging here is probably a full blown field of science. After all, the human brain is the single most complicated structure ever discovered, and what we are examining here is an even more complicated subversion of that system. And what this implies is that, just as with any other field of

science, it is probably a game that is always only going to be open to a much rarer and far more capable few.

SECTION 8: THE FIRE BOX (THE PROTOCOL OF SAFETY)

Introduction: The magnitude of this discovery creates a dilemma. If the solution is this powerful, why not broadcast it to the world? Here, we establish the "Rules of Engagement." We explain why a "loud" approach fails, and why we must build a containment structure (The Fire Box) before we strike the match.

Safety First: The Rules of Engagement

As we come to the end here, we are left with some very big questions. If it is that big, and that important, then why not just make a big noise about it? Why not start a podcast, or stand up on the TED stage?

There are several good reasons for this. Firstly, because doing that would have no effect at all.

Nobody would even hear it.

The Fire in the Rain Our current situation really is like trying to light a fire in the rain. There is wet wood everywhere. If what you want is a nice warm fire out in the woods, do you hold a match against an old wet log?. No. That's simply not how you make a fire.

You need very dry wood, in a very particular kind of arrangement, and then you need to apply intense heat in a very focused manner. Only then do things suddenly change, with the focus suddenly becoming one of how to *contain* the fire rather than how to generate it. And this is why we need a Fire Box established, before we even begin.

The Deep End of the Pool

We sometimes use the deep end of the pool as another metaphor in this regard. You really don't want to go around throwing people who can't swim into the deep end. It can be very tempting! But you also don't want to make the deep end shallow just because some people can't swim, because that would defeat the whole purpose.

Basically, what we need is to put a **fence** up, and to erect a very clear sign, thereby giving people fair warning. The same fence also allows us to keep anyone out who does not meet the minimum standards associated.

The idea is to curate a space, and to provide a filter. The point is that this important cultural boundary has to go both ways. It needs to allow all those who clearly qualify access to the deep end of the pool, but it must also pull people who can't swim out of the water when necessary.

No Pushing

This is a very important thing to understand - what we see emerging here is not a social movement. There is no sense here that most people should even be made aware, and nobody should ever be pressed toward it.

This is why every person needs to be able to make that decision for themselves in full awareness, and to simply walk away if they wish. So they need to be able to see the deep end, but without being pushed in with all their clothes on. It is a delicate balance - in that we are essentially making people broadly aware of a hidden process that is intentionally withholding the very awareness we are offering.

Hence: You might even be feeling a bit frustrated at this moment, as if we are talking a lot but never really getting to the point. But this is intentional.

I am very deliberately not giving you quite enough information here to fully grasp what I am saying. This is the fine line we are walking here. It is all about mutual respect and consideration. Typical culture and this newly emerging event are entirely complementary to each other, but only provided they can always be kept sufficiently apart.

PART IV: THE INVITATION

SECTION 9: THE AVATAR (BORN, NOT MADE)

Introduction: Who is this for? We conclude by profiling the specific type of mind capable of holding this paradox. We address the "Intelligence Trap" - why smart people often avoid this topic - and define the specific "broken bunker" trait that qualifies a person for 2EQ.

The Final Lesson: Born That Way

Surely you have to be asking yourself by now whether I actually believe anything I am saying here. But yes, I really do. I think this 'sudden and permanent release' possibility is absolutely a reality for every person. I also believe that we now only need the map to be rendered in the right terms, and that the only thing required for that will be to bounce the whole thing off a few of the **right people**.

But I don't believe that people will generally rise to this challenge. I have zero faith that anyone will rise to the demands associated, even though - from my perspective - they seem so very low. And I don't believe this based on a huge amount of direct personal experience. And yet, I do believe in rare exceptions.

So who are we looking for here? How would you recognise them?

These people may not be who you imagine. To be truly qualified for what is emerging here might not even make you particularly capable in any normal worldly sense. It might just make you a bit weird. It is a rare psychological combination. They might be blisteringly smart in certain regards, but they may also clearly be **on fire** in some sense.

It is almost as if the psychological bunker we are all hiding in is a bit **broken** for these people, so that they can see a bit of light through the cracks. They already know at some level that the small emotional space they are crammed into is not the whole picture. So for them it is no surprise.

Here we also strike a far wider issue, which is that 'capture' and 'qualification' tend to be diametrically opposed. You would imagine that academics would be the most highly qualified, but the problem with a very high degree of functional integrity is that it will necessarily demand tremendous force be applied over time by this subversive agenda in other areas of the system.

Basically, the bigger your head grows, the smaller your testicles will tend to become, so to speak. We even have special containment facilities for such people, which we tend to call 'universities'. It really is true that receptivity and capability are rarely found together in this sense.

Therefore, how do you know if you qualify for 2EQ? It's very simple: You will not immediately assume that it will be someone else that will ignite this whole thing. On the contrary, you immediately understand that it must be you, it can only be you, and that it was always going to be you. Of course.

Put bluntly, the people we are looking for here cannot be made - they can only be found. They are simply **born that way**. Built for this task. Recognition will be immediate, and interest will not need to be stoked. So if that's not the response you get from anyone, then just let it go, and move on.

SECTION 10: THE ASSIGNMENT (PASS IT UPWARDS)

Introduction: The final instruction. Simple, strict, and binary. We define the "One Shot" rule to ensure this spreads only through high-integrity channels, protecting the signal from the noise.

Pass It Upwards: The One Shot Rule

So here we see the primary injunction in its most simple terms: Share this. Feel free. But only ever share it with one person - that person being the single smartest and most capable person you know.

But won't this limit its spread? Yes. That would be the whole point. This game is all about **quality, not quantity**. We really are only talking about a handful of people here. So if we end up with only a dozen people in the room, that would be great.

The Rule: Choose wisely, pass it on personally, and never knock twice. Don't bug anyone with this. Once is a gift. But twice would probably be abuse. Which means you really only get one shot.

When someone is ready for this, they are always ready immediately.

The only thing that really needs to occur now is for the right information to be placed in the hands of the right people in the right terms. It is all about providing an opportunity for those very competent individuals to exercise the **benefit of the doubt** until that doubt is either confirmed or exhausted.

Something this dramatic really needs to be challenged, rather than simply accepted. Only a complete idiot would simply swallow a claim so dramatic. It needs to be able to take the heat. So people need to **bring the heat**. Robust debate is the whole point in the first instance.

So that's the game. It needs to be passed upwards. And who is going to do that?

You are.

And if not you, then who?

Don't look at me, I am already doing my part, and then some. But the events we are defining here are collective by definition, and therefore beyond the reach of any individual by default. But for the collective it will all be easy. So now is our chance. The real target has finally come into view here.

We are an inch away from changing the entire world here - and the bit that comes next is **you**.